

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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FORGET NOT ALL HIS BENEFITS Psalms 103

Our whole being to praise God. *Psalms 103 Praise the Lord, O my soul; all my inmost being, praise his holy name. 2 Praise the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits —*

Who forgives, heals & redeems

3 who forgives all your sins and heals all your diseases, 4 who redeems your life from the pit and crowns you with love and compassion,

Who satisfies *5 who satisfies your desires with good things so that your youth is renewed like the eagle's.*

Justness & fairness for the oppressed *6 The Lord works righteousness and justice for all the oppressed. 7 He made known his ways to Moses, his deeds to the people of Israel:*

Slow to anger *8 The Lord is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in love. 9 He will not always accuse, nor will he harbor his anger forever;*

10 He does not treat us as our sins deserve or repay us according to our iniquities.

Great is his love *11 For as high as the heavens are above the earth, so great is his love for those who fear him;*

Removes our sins *12 as far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us.*

A compassionate father *13 As a father has compassion on his children, so the Lord has compassion on those who fear him;*

He sees our vulnerability *14 for he knows how we are formed, he remembers that we are dust. 15 As for man, his days are like grass, he flourishes like a flower of the field; 16 the wind blows over it and it is gone, and its place remembers it no more.*

His love is everlasting *17 But from everlasting to everlasting the Lord's love is with those who fear him, and his righteousness with their children's children — 18 with those who keep his covenant and remember to obey his precepts.*

Established his authority *19 The Lord has established his throne in heaven, and his kingdom rules overall. 20 Praise the Lord, you his angels, you mighty ones who do his bidding, who obey his word. 21 Praise the Lord, all his heavenly hosts, you his servants who do his will. 22 Praise the Lord, all his works everywhere in his dominion. Praise the Lord, O my soul. NIV*

IT IS IMPORTANT THAT WE CONSTANTLY READ AND BE REMINDED OF THE BENEFITS of God BUT IT IS NOW TIME FOR EACH OF US TO REMEMBER, REFLECT ON AND NAME THE BENEFITS THAT HAVE ACTUALLY HAPPENED IN OUR OWN LIVES.

SO, THIS IS WHERE WE ACTUALLY COUNT OUR BLESSINGS, NAMING THEM ONE BY ONE.

I PRESENT TO YOU THAT:

IT IS TIME

THAT WE BEGAN TO ENUMERATE (NAME) AND SPECIFICALLY RECALL ACTUAL EVENTS AND SITUATIONS THAT EACH ONE OF US HAS PERSONALLY EXPERIENCED SINCE WE CAME TO CHRIST –

AND WE GIVE THANKS VERBALLY – OUT LOUD TO OURSELVES WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THE RECIPIENTS OF HIS BENEFITS.

EXAMPLE

I AM REFERRING TO THOSE MIRACLES, HEALINGS, DELIVERANCES FROM DEATH OR DANGER, THOSE INTERVENTIONS OF GOD IN OUR LIVES THAT CHANGED OUR ATTITUDE AND WAY OF THINKING ABOUT OUR HEAVENLY FATHER.

AND

THOSE TIMES WHEN GOD REMOVED THE OBSTACLES THAT HINDERED OR THREATENED TO OPPOSE OUR ADVANCEMENT IN THE FIELD OF EMPLOYMENT OR MINISTRY EXPRESSION.

AND

THOSE PERSONAL DELIVERANCES AND VICTORIES GAINED IN YOUR OWN LIFE OVER THE CARNALITY AND THE WORKS OF THE FLESH.

IT IS TIME

LET US MAKE A COMMITMENT TO TAKE TIME OUT NOW – STARTING TODAY AND CONTINUING TO DO IT EVERY DAY FOR THE NEXT 7 DAYS.

MY TESTIMONY

- I remember some of the benefits that I have received at certain times in my journey of serving Christ.
- There were those times when I can only say that there was invisible angel keeping me from crashing and certain death in our small aeroplane and from being killed or seriously harmed from tribal fighting in various parts of PNG.
- And on our mission trips, protection from the dangers of the 30-year civil war that raged in Sri Lanka, where we were exposed to suicide bombers, land mines, artillery shelling daily or caught in the crossfire between Government armed forces and the rebels seeking separate independence.
- And also, his preserving me when I was involved in a head-on crash in a vehicle in PNG that hospitalized me (and others) with the real possibility that I might not be able to walk, run or travel overseas again to continue ministering the Gospel to the nations. But God intervened and within 3 months I was again ministering in Sri Lanka PTL.
- And there were those times I was miraculously healed, and my wife and I saw our Children miraculously healed and provided for.
- Then there were those times when God's specific encouraging word came to us as we faced serious tragedy and crisis – e.g. the loss of life in the crash of our airplane P@UIF, the sinking at sea of our evangelism boat the Mauri Dalana, the deliberate burning down of our first Bethel Church building, the loss of lives and all equipment through the volcanoes in PNG, and the murders of our Christian brothers and sisters from persecution.
- I remember all his benefits and thank God for his keeping and healing and delivering power in my life and that of my wife and children.
- HOWEVER, THE MOST SIGNIFICANT MIRACLE THAT HAPPENED TO ME was in the Philippines when I seriously thought death was very near as malaria and dysentery raged in my body for over a week without access to medication and then the Holy Spirit brought God's word to me from Psalms 71:17-18 and I was instantly healed and raised up and I travelled home to Australia the next day.
- I WOULD BE MINISTERING TO THIS GENERATION AND TO THE NEXT GENERATION TO COME.
Psalms 71:18 Yes, even when I am old and gray-headed, O God, forsake me not, [but keep me alive] until I have declared Your mighty strength to [this] generation, and your might and power to all that are to come. AMP
- WHAT A MIGHTY GOD WE HAVE – WHAT A WONDERFUL SAVIOUR IS JESUS OUR LORD.
Exodus 15:1-2 - Then Moses and the people of Israel sang this song to the Lord, saying, "I will sing to the Lord, for he has triumphed gloriously; the horse and his rider he has thrown into the sea. - 2 The Lord is my strength and my song, and he has become my salvation; this is my God, and I will praise him, my father's God, and I will exalt him. ESV

AMEN – Ps Barry